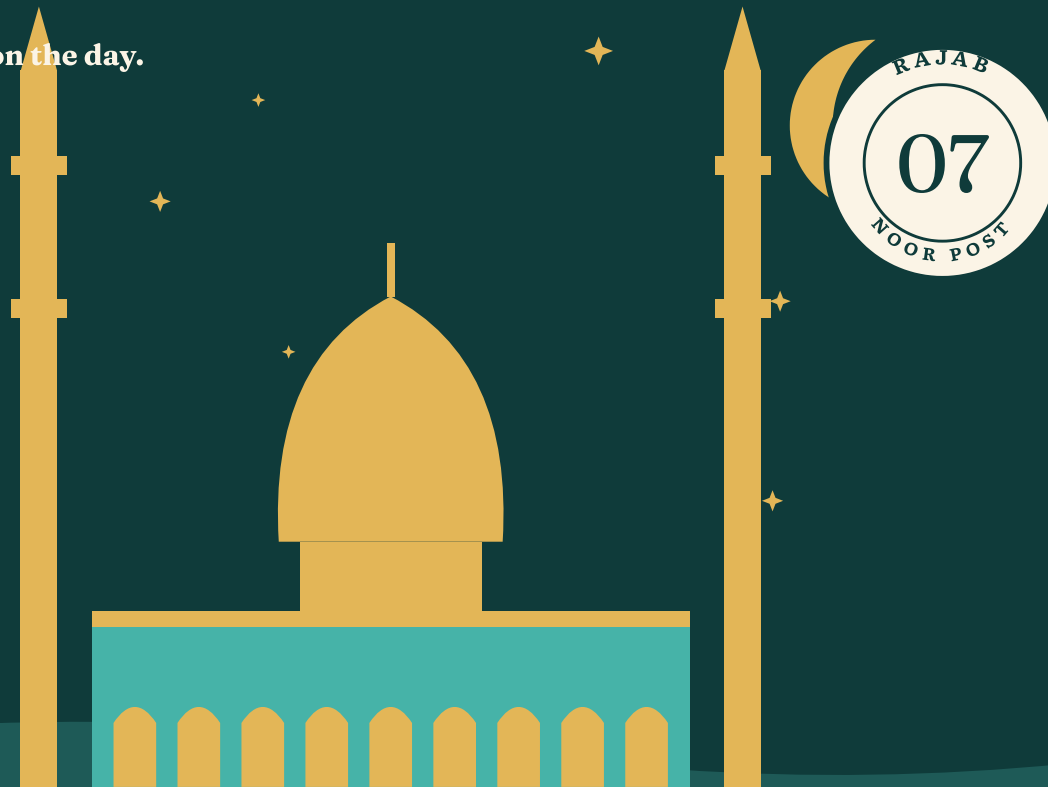


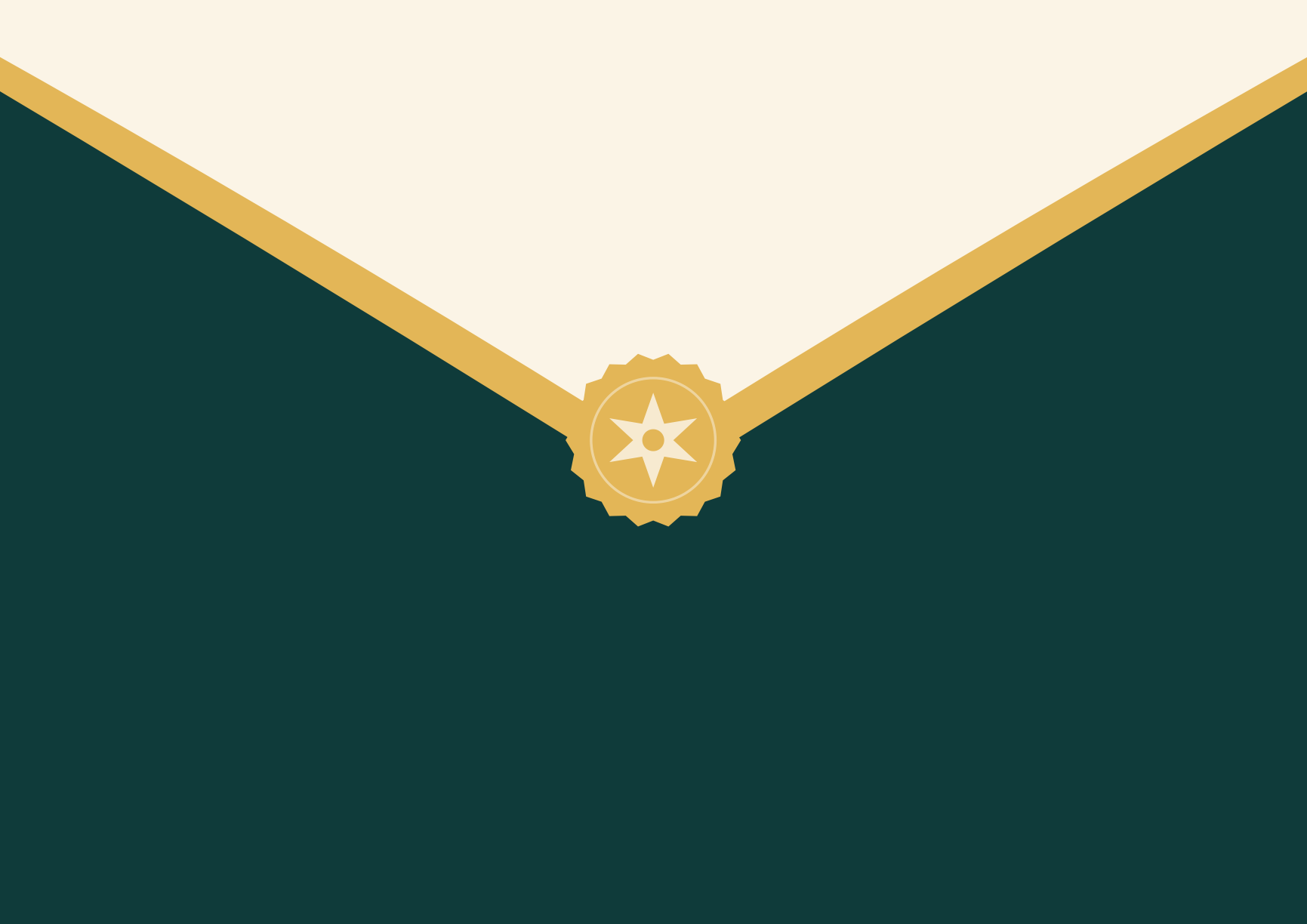
NOOR POST

One of fourteen. Open it on the day.



FOR

[Child's name]



ENVELOPE 07 • RAJAB •
INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

🕒 **About twenty-five
minutes**

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The prints
- 4 Talk about it
- 5 The stickers
- 6 The postcard



FACT PANEL

Imam Ali ibn Abi Talib

(peace be upon him)

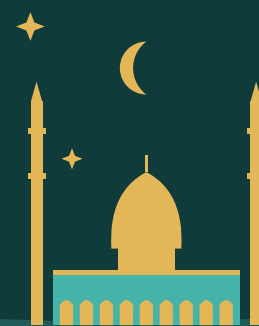
B. 13 RAJAB, ABOUT 30 YEARS BEFORE THE HIJRA, MAKKAH • D. 40 AH, KUFA

- **Where and when.** Makkah, then Medina, then Kufa — a garrison town in Iraq that he made his capital because it was where the people were, not because it was comfortable.
- **Who was ruling.** Him. This is the only envelope in the box where the family is the government, and that is what makes the letter possible. Everything he could have done, he could actually have done.
- **The imamate and the caliphate.** The imamate about thirty years, from 11 AH. The caliphate about four and a half years, from 35 AH. **Note the gap between those two numbers.** For twenty-four years he was not in charge of anything.
- **What he left.** Letters and sermons, collected about three hundred and fifty years later into the book called Nahj al-Balagha. His instructions to Malik al-Ashtar on how to govern Egypt are in it — a long letter about how to treat people you have power over, written by someone who had it.
- **Fatima bint Asad.** His mother. She raised the Prophet in her own house after his grandfather died, and the accounts hold that she gave birth to Ali inside the Kaaba itself.
- **Elsewhere in the world.** In the same years, across the world in the forests of Central America, the Maya were cutting dates into stone at cities like Tikal — a different empire, a different calendar, and also writing down who ruled and when.

He was killed in the masjid at Kufa in 40 AH, during the dawn prayer, by Abd al-Rahman ibn Muljam.

ENVELOPE 07 • RAJAB

Two Loaves



● is the grown-up • ○ is you • ●○ is together

- A man called Uthman ibn Hunayf was the governor of Basra. One evening a rich family in the city invited him to dinner, and he went.

○ Is that not allowed?

- On its own it is fine. But at that door the poor had been turned away and only the rich let in. Somebody noticed, and wrote to Kufa about it. Kufa was a long ride from Basra, so the news took days to arrive and the answer took days to come back.
- The man in Kufa was running everything from Egypt to the edge of India. He had given the governor the job himself. He could have taken it back that morning.

○ Did he?

- He wrote him a letter instead.

○ What did he say in it?

- That he had heard about the dinner. That the dishes had come in many colours and the bowls had been large. And then he did something strange. He began describing his own house.

○ Why his own house?

TWO LOAVES · CONTINUED

- So the governor would know what the ruler of the empire actually kept in it. Two pieces of cloth, both worn thin. Bread, enough for the day. That was the list, and it was the whole list.
- Every storehouse between Egypt and India would have opened if he had asked for it. He did not ask.
- **Was he punishing himself?**
- No — and he said so. He wrote plainly that he was not asking the governor to live the same way. He said he knew he could not ask that of him.
- **Then what did he want?**
- Help holding the line. That was all he asked for. And he left the man in his job.
- **Would you have written, or fired him? Say it before we go on.**
- Nobody remembers that dinner now. Nobody remembers the family who gave it. Not the storehouses either. What lasted is the letter — copied out by hand for thirteen hundred years, because of what a man with everything within reach said he had at home.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦
**Two worn cloths. Bread
for the day. One letter.**



Then the hadith card.

IMAM ALI SAID

**“The value of a man is
what he does expertly.”**

Imam Ali

NOOR POST · THE FOURTEEN

The chain

Every card in this box is one link. Lay all fourteen in order and the chain runs from the Prophet to the last of the twelve, each one passing on what was given.



Fourteen segments · historical order

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims, no. 8. Translated by Badr Shahin,
Ansariyan Publications, Qum.



Talk about it

About ten minutes. No right answers, and no points.

2

• Grown-up answers this one first.

Tell about a time you asked someone to do something you were not doing yourself.

3

He described his own house instead of giving an order. Why do you think he did it that way?

TURN OVER →



TALK ABOUT IT • CONTINUED

4 He said he was not asking the governor to live like him. Was that letting him off, or something else?

5 **▮ This one is hard for a grown-up.**

He kept him in the job. If you had written that letter, could you have kept him?

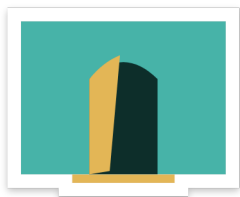
LAST

One of you names something in this house there is enough of. The other names something there is exactly enough of. Go and look at both.











**We opened this one
together.**

● _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

